



SIPPING ON LEGENDS

From the medicinal mojito to the Florence-born negroni, here are the stories behind some famous cocktails

BY SMITA TRIPATHI

A **MARTINI, SHAKEN NOT STIRRED**” said James Bond in Sean Connery’s third appearance as Bond in the 1964 film *Goldfinger*, and single-handedly made it one of the most fashionable drinks in popular culture. But did Bond get it wrong? Should a martini be stirred and not shaken. “A shaken martini is way colder for the first few moments after it’s poured but soon after it creeps up to room temperature. And no one likes a room temperature martini. A stirred martini will have less dilution and stay colder longer. So if you prefer your martinis sipped in a couple of sips, nice and snappy, like Bond, have it shaken. Me, I like to savour mine so I’ll have it stirred,” says Joe McCanta, Global Brand Ambassador, Grey Goose. However, he adds: “The truth is the martini is the only drink that you can completely make your own. So I would say, the perfect recipe is however you like it! I like mine with a 5:1 ratio (five parts vodka, one part vermouth) with a dash of orange bitters—stirred, not shaken (sorry James!) and garnished with a lemon twist.”

Traditionally, a martini is a gin-based cocktail but over the years it has become equally popular as a vodka cocktail. There are several stories related to the origin of the martini. A favourite theory goes that Italian bartender Martini di Arma made the first martini in 1911 for John D. Rockefeller who was a frequent guest at the Knickerbocker Hotel in New York City. He loved the